Straight lines

Straight lines are usually used to break up and define other, more bold details, especially in the case of fillets. Without fillets, beads and coves will flow into each other in a very wishy washy sort of way. The definition that this tiny detail brings is surprising, but important to traditionally turned designs. You will see that they appear often in the photos throughout this article and indeed no doubt throughout the magazine.

Collars are wider straight sections that appear usually at the top of a turning and are often used on mass-produced turnings to put working room between a square pommel and the first turned detail on stair spindles and furniture legs. Hand turners don't need this detail as a sharp skew will cut details very close together, but a copy lathe will not be able to produce this level of detail with the large scraping cutters that are used.

V-cuts are quite self explanatory, used on things like meat tenderisers and foot massagers to create crisp V-shaped details. When a small V-cut is used to separate or define another detail, such as between the reels or as on the legs of my oak (*Quercus robur*) stool, this is known as a quirk.

The legs of my oak stool feature a small V-cut to highlight the shape of the legs, known as a quirk

TOP TIP: GOOD USE OF A FILLET

The angled fillet is often subtle but incredibly effective

Sometimes you will notice a fillet is slightly tipped back towards a neighbouring bead. This is sometimes quite subtle and at other times very obvious, and is because fillets look best when they are set at less than 90° to the detail next to them. If a bead finishes at an angle to its base, to maintain an angle less than 90° and make it look its best, the fillet will traditionally be cut at an angle.

Combinations

What do you get when you cross a bead with a cove...? Although it sounds like the beginning of a poor joke, this combination is how more advanced shapes are created. An ogee, for example, is a hollow shape that flows into a rounded shape to form a flowing S-shaped curve. Done well, an ogee is a beautifully graceful shape that is incredibly versatile which can be found in both spindle and faceplate work, being able to be stretched out wide for the underside of a platter, or stretched up tall for a deep bowl or vase form – as seen in the work of the late Bert Marsh who was known for his beautiful ogee forms – see overleaf.

Getting technical, an ogee comes in two forms which are recognised by their Latin names of cyma recta and cyma reversa. Cyma is the overall ogee or S shape, the recta and reversa refer to the balance of the shape. The recta has the hollow or concave portion at the top of the shape, whereas the cyma reversa has the rounded, or convex portion at the top of the shape. A combination commonly found in many spindle turnings is a tulip shape, which is once again a combination of a rounded and a hollow shape, and shown as the top section on the oak lamp in the picture.

Oak platter using an ogee shape

A maple (*Acer saccharum*) bowl, a very different shaped bowl to the platter, but the ogee works here too

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